

ALONG THE SIDELINES

EDWIN POPE

Some of Stanky Stays in St. Louis; The Introduction of Cohen and Pilney

Baseball Once Over Lightly: Eddie Stanky runs the Minneapolis Millers now but his spirit still hangs heavy over Freddie Hutchinson's St. Louis Cardinals. No Card will wear his old No. 12. . . . The Federal Penitentiary here puts out one of the most complete baseball handbooks around. Trouble is, you have to be a "member" to get one. . . . And if Nashville's Thomas Michael Brown isn't the most-nicknamed player in the Southern Assn., who is? Old pro Brown answers to Tommy, Buckshot or City.



Pope

Merry madcap Kirby Higbe, who stopped with the Crackers for an interesting while, turned 41 in Columbia, S.C., the other day. . . . New Orleans Manager Andy Cohen remembers with misgivings his first meeting with Tulane football coach Andy Pilney. "I was managing Dayton in the 1930s," Cohen says. "Pilney had graduated from Notre Dame and joined Ernie. One day we're playing Erie and I'm covering second. A guy hits a ball past me. I miss it. When I look up, the guy is racing to second. Our right fielder fumbles the ball and it gets away. The guy scores. 'Who's that?' I ask. And someone tells me, 'That's Pilney, the fast guy from Notre Dame.' " . . . Georgia State League hitters complain they're handicapped powerwise by the cheap-grade ball used there. . . . REAL Mag is out with a piece quoting ball-players on the most overrated and underrated big-leaguers. They call Yankee outfielder Hank Bauer the American's most underrated. It's Redleg outfielder Wally Post in the National. The two leagues' most overrated: Don Newcombe, Dodger pitcher, and Jim Piersall, Red Sox flychaser. And Red Socker Billy Goodman, the ex-Cracker, surprisingly is called the American's most overrated second baseman.

—Bender Has a Theory

Sheldon Bender, Albany general manager, blames hard-to-please ump's for some dullness in games. "They've narrowed the strike zone down so much," Bender says, "all the batters wait out the pitchers." . . . Milwaukee's Ed Matthews thinks New York's Willie Mays will be his toughest competition for the National League home run crown. "But Willie won't bust Babe Ruth's record of 60," says Matthews. "A lefty will do that." . . . The rush has started on ballots for the most valuable



Ed Matthews

high school player in Greater Atlanta. Winner will collect his trophy May 18 at The Atlanta Journal's all-star game. . . . That springtime after-hours auto crash of Don Larsen didn't hurt the Yankee pitcher to amount to anything but you should have seen the telephone pole. Cost \$350 to replace it.

—Yanks' Martin, Tech's Menger

Any time a general manager (like Wid Matthews of the Cubs) says he wouldn't take \$500,000 for a player (like Ernie Banks), I figure he's a flop as a businessman. . . . Opposite extremes are Kentucky's basketball and baseball teams. The Wildcat cats had a .215 batting average (with nary a home run) and an .890 fielding percentage in dropping 16 of their first 17 games. . . . Cracker president Earl Mann says he knows an old baseball scout who threw a party to celebrate the anniversary of the unemployment compensation act. . . . Near-est collegiate equivalent of Yankee fireball Billy Martin: Georgia Tech's Johnny Menger. . . . Of the seven Class D leagues left in baseball, four are at least partly in Georgia and Florida. They're the Georgia-Florida, Georgia State, Alabama-Florida and Florida State.

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—Whisenant-Mauch 'Reunion?'

Memphis co-owner Leo Burson has a 13-year-old daughter who was offered a screen test. The Bursons said thanks but they'd wait awhile. . . . You think it's tough here? Wichita and Omaha used 11 pitchers in an early game. Wichita boss George Selkirk sent out four in the ninth inning alone. . . . Pete Whisenant Only Georgia-based ump in the Southern Assn. is Back With Pal? Henry Grady Holcombe of Canton. . . . If the Cubs send Pete Whisenant to Los Angeles, he'll be back with old playmate Gene Mauch, the Angels' second baseman. Which should be interesting, inasmuch as Whisenant was one of Mauch's chief problem children with the 1953 Crackers.



Pete Whisenant